

Group Project: Design and Run an AI Policy Simulation

Interactive Simulation: Governing the AI Future

What this is. Your four-person team will design and run a live AI policy simulation during the final class. You will receive a **24-minute block**: 17 minutes for preparation, the hearing, and the decision; 5 minutes for your debrief and recommendation; and 2 minutes for the transition to the next team. The goal is to help the class experience the political, ethical, and strategic complexity of a real, high-stakes decision. This is not a research presentation or a business plan. It is a structured exercise in political decision-making, based on the Day 4 data-center town hall.

How the Class Will Participate

The class already has five teams of four students. During each simulation:

1. One team presents. Its four members run the simulation and do not play stakeholder or panel roles.
2. At the start of the five-minute preparation period, the presenting team gives one role card to each of the other four teams.
3. Three teams receive stakeholder cards. The fourth team receives the decision-panel card.

Each role card is therefore written for a full team of four students. A stakeholder team chooses one member to give its opening statement. After that, any member may answer questions, respond to another stakeholder, or negotiate. The four students on the decision panel work together to ask questions, deliberate, and announce one decision.

What Your Team Will Do

Your team will:

- Choose one specific and debatable AI policy decision.
- Identify the public body or institution with authority to decide.
- Prepare one common briefing, three stakeholder-group cards, and one decision-panel card.
- Run the simulation, distribute roles, clarify facts, moderate, and manage the clock.
- Lead a five-minute debrief and give a short policy recommendation.

Choosing a Topic

Choose a real and current policy decision related to AI governance or the political economy of AI. The decision may concern any part of the AI stack, including:

- chips, computing capacity, cloud services, or data centers;
- training data, copyright, privacy, or access to data;
- model development, safety testing, release, or liability;
- AI applications in employment, education, health, government, elections, or security; or
- competition, labor, energy, environmental impacts, or international governance.

Your topic must:

- identify a specific government, regulator, court, company, or international body with authority to decide;
- present one concrete decision with a small number of possible outcomes;
- create meaningful disagreement among three stakeholder groups;
- connect to ideas or evidence from the course; and

- be narrow enough to address during the simulation.

Do not submit a broad subject such as “AI and copyright” or “AI safety.” Turn it into a decision question, such as: “Should AI companies be required to disclose copyrighted works used in model training?” Topics require instructor approval to confirm that they fit the course, are sufficiently specific, and do not duplicate another team’s simulation.

Required Timing: 24 Minutes

1. **Role preparation — 5 minutes.** Participating groups read their cards, identify their main goals, and choose an opening speaker. The presenting team may clarify facts but may not coach positions.
2. **Stakeholder opening statements — 3 minutes.** Each of the three stakeholder groups receives approximately one minute.
3. **Panel questions and negotiation — 6 minutes.** The panel questions the stakeholders. Stakeholders may respond to one another and propose compromises.
4. **Panel deliberation and decision — 3 minutes.** The panel discusses the options and announces one clear decision.
5. **Presenting-team debrief and recommendation — 5 minutes.** Your team identifies the main trade-offs, evaluates the panel’s decision, and gives its own recommendation.
6. **Changeover — 2 minutes.** The next presenting team sets up.

Five 24-minute blocks fill the two-hour simulation period.

The Decision

Every simulation must revolve around one concrete decision. The decision must be difficult, but the available choices must be clear. For example:

Should the government require a safety audit before a company may release a frontier AI model?

The panel must have authority within the simulation and must announce a decision before the hearing ends. The presenting team should define the available choices and any limits on the panel’s authority. Do not end with discussion alone.

How to Prepare

Your recommendation should reflect the political and institutional issues raised during the hearing, not just your personal opinion. Your team should:

- **Frame the problem:** What is being decided? Why is it urgent? Who has authority? Who may benefit, pay, or bear risk?
- **Use evidence:** Draw on course readings and credible current sources. Identify competing values, institutional limits, and relevant historical context.
- **Create distinct roles:** Give each stakeholder a different goal, position, and result it cannot accept.
- **Design real conflict:** Choose disagreements that reveal important policy trade-offs rather than simple misunderstandings.
- **Prepare to adapt:** Plan how you will interpret the discussion, but do not write the panel’s decision or your final recommendation in advance.

Required Simulation Materials

- **Common briefing — maximum one page.** Explain the decision, essential facts, stakes, and available options. Every participant receives this.
- **Three stakeholder-group cards — maximum one page each.** Each card gives one group its role, position, main goal, important facts, and one result it cannot accept.
- **One decision-panel card — maximum one page.** State the available decisions, the panel's authority, decision criteria, and decision rule.
- **Run-of-show.** List the timing, speaking order, role assignments, and the tasks of each presenting-team member.
- **Slides — maximum three.** Use slides only for shared facts, the decision, timing, or voting. Slides support the simulation; they do not replace it.
- **Sources.** Include a short reference list and cite factual claims on slides or in the common briefing.

Responsibilities of the Presenting Team

All four members must take an active role. Divide responsibility for:

- moderating the hearing;
- managing time and transitions;
- operating slides and clarifying common facts; and
- leading the debrief and recommendation.

Role Cards

Role cards are starting points, not scripts. Use plain language and keep each role internally coherent. Participants must develop arguments in their own words and react to the hearing. Do not tell them exactly what compromise to offer.

Each stakeholder-group card should include:

- group name and role;
- position on the decision;
- main goal and motivation;
- one or two important facts; and
- one result the group cannot accept.

The decision-panel card should include:

- the available decisions;
- the panel's authority and limits;
- two or three criteria to consider; and
- the method for reaching and announcing a decision.

Deliverables

Email all deliverables to stephen.weymouth@georgetown.edu. Use the same subject line for every submission: **AI Policy Simulation — Group [number]**.

- **Tuesday of Week 2 — Topic Approval Request.** Submit one paragraph stating the topic, the exact decision question, who has authority to decide, and why the decision is urgent. Also list the proposed three stakeholder groups and the decision panel. You must receive topic approval before submitting the final packet.
- **Thursday of Week 2, before class — Final Simulation Packet.** Email the common briefing, three stakeholder-group cards, decision-panel card, run-of-show, maximum three slides, and source

list.

- **Thursday of Week 2 — In-Class Simulation.** Run your assigned 24-minute block during the final session. Be ready to distribute roles and begin preparation immediately.

Grading Rubric

- **Simulation Design (30%)** — A realistic, engaging scenario with a clear decision and meaningful conflict.
- **Execution (30%)** — Effective facilitation, clear instructions, good timing, and appropriate adaptation to the discussion. You are not graded on whether participants reach a particular outcome.
- **Policy Insight (20%)** — The debrief and recommendation use evidence and respond to the political and institutional trade-offs raised in the hearing.
- **Preparation (20%)** — Materials are complete, clear, polished, properly sourced, and submitted on time.

Unless otherwise stated, all members receive one group grade.

Final Advice

- Focus on trade-offs, not ideal outcomes.
- Make the decision difficult, but make the rules clear.
- Use real-world logic: institutions have limits, and stakeholders have different forms of power.
- Keep the simulation moving. A clear decision under time pressure is better than an unfinished discussion.

Questions? Reach out early. I am happy to review your ideas and offer feedback.